Episode 5: *The Sunken Sanctuary (ប្រាសាទលិចទឹក)*

Full Game Design & Narrative Specification Document

1. Overview & General Info

- **Title: Boon Sop**: The Unbroken Debt — Episode 5: The Sunken Sanctuary
- **Time Period**: 1932 (French Protectorate Era in Cambodia)
- **Protagonist**: Sora ([illegible] - Age 24) – Armed with her sketchbook, oil lantern, compass, and the four broken seal remnants recovered across Cambodia.
- **Location**: Phnom Kulen Sacred Mountain & Ancient Subterranean Temple Catacombs, Siem Reap / Northern Region, Cambodia
- **Time of Event**: 3:00 AM to Dawn (Final Climax)
- **Estimated Playtime**: 3.5 to 4.5 Hours
- **Genre**: 3D First-Person Atmospheric Survival Horror (Multi-Room Puzzle Architecture & Boss Ritual Avoidance)
- **Engine Target**: Babylon.js / PlayCanvas (WebGPU/WebGL native in-browser)
- **Visual Aesthetic**: Ancient mossy sandstone grey, glowing spirit ambers, deep jungle greens, emissive golden runes, volumetric mist, and a dramatic transition to warm golden morning sunlight.

2. Character Profiles

- **Sora (ស[illegible]ខ[illegible]):** Exhausted, battle-tested, and carrying the weight of four generations of family history. She uses everything she has learned—stealth, audio tracking, spatial awareness, and ritual knowledge—to face the ancient guardian spirit.

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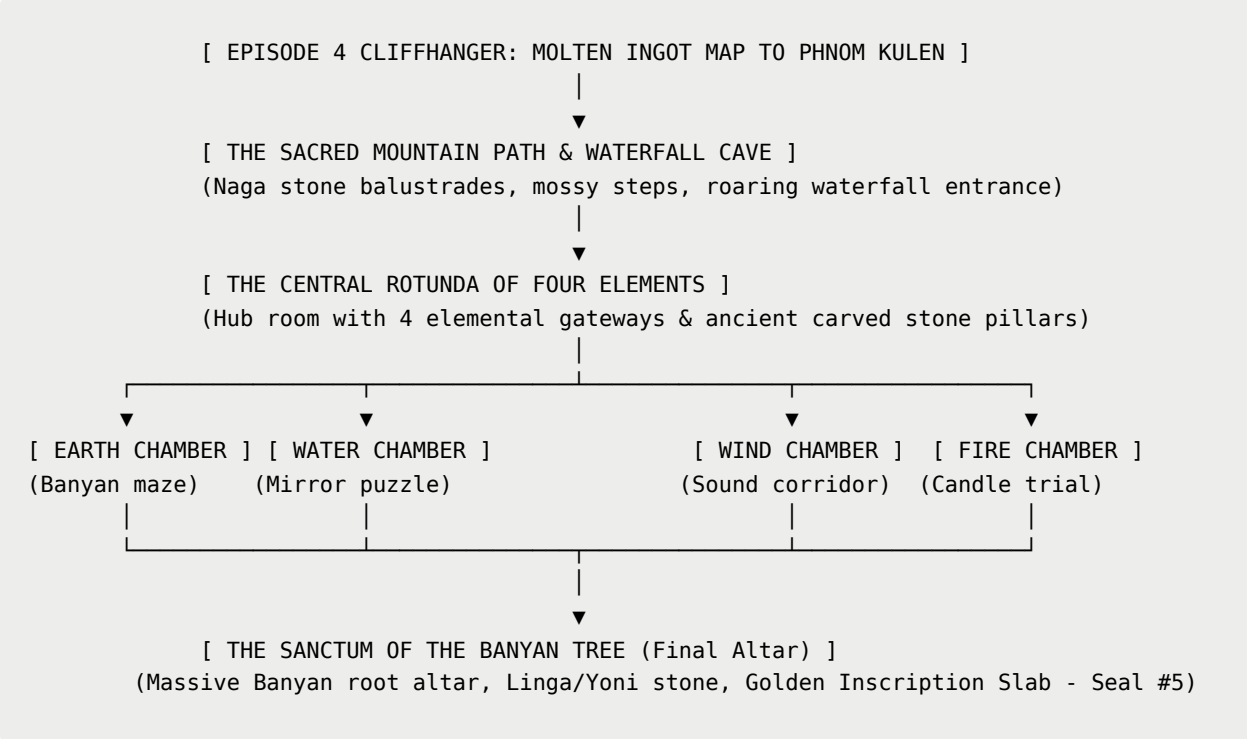
- **The Neak Ta Guardian (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□)**: The prime, fully manifested land guardian entity. A towering, multi-armed silhouette wearing a distorted, glowing ancient brass mask (Mukhalingi). It commands the temple catacombs, bending spatial geometry and light to protect its contract.
- **Ancestral Voices (Spirits of Uncle Sok & Great-Grandfather)**: Echoing memory manifestations that guide or test Sora through interactive choices inside the trial chambers.

3. Environment & Spatial Layout



1. Mountain Approach & Waterfall Entrance

- **Structure**: A steep, ancient sandstone staircase carved directly into the jungle cliffside, flanked by moss-covered seven-headed Naga serpent balustrades. Hidden behind a roaring waterfall lies the entrance to the catacombs.
- **Props**: Fallen stone carvings, ancient Khmer boundary pillars (*Sima*), flickering stone oil braziers, and overgrown banyan tree roots.

2. Central Rotunda of the Four Elements

- **Architecture**: A massive circular subterranean chamber constructed from carved sandstone blocks. In the center stands a stone relief map of Cambodia. Four monumental archways lead to the elemental trial chambers.

3. The Four Elemental Trial Chambers

- **Earth Chamber (Chamber of Roots)**: A labyrinth of massive Banyan tree roots (*Sprean*) bursting through stone walls, creating shifting maze pathways.
- **Water Chamber (Chamber of Reflections)**: Submerged stone basins fed by mountain springs, lined with Apsara bas-relief carvings reflecting light beams off the water.
- **Wind Chamber (Chamber of Whispers)**: A narrow, stone-carved corridor lined with ancient Pali inscriptions where heavy wind gusts howl through stone lattice grilles.
- **Fire Chamber (Chamber of Flames)**: A high-temperature chamber lit by rows of ancient iron oil braziers and stone incense altars.

4. The Final Sanctum (*The Banyan Altar*)

- **Architecture**: A towering circular stone sanctum with an open dome ceiling revealing the night sky above. In the center grows a massive ancient Banyan tree whose roots wrap around a sacred stone altar (*Linga/Yoni*) holding the Golden Inscription Slab (Seal #5).

4. Act Breakdown & Detailed Narrative

Act I: The Mountain Path & The Four Gateways (0:00 – 1:00)

Narrative

At 3:00 AM, Sora reaches the sacred mountain of Phnom Kulen. Guided by her sketchbook and the molten ingot, she climbs the ancient Naga staircase through tropical mist, entering the hidden cave behind a roaring waterfall.

Inside, she reaches the Central Rotunda of the Four Elements. In the center, a stone altar displays four empty niches corresponding to the four artifacts she destroyed across Episodes 1–4. To break the main entrance seal leading into the Final Sanctum, Sora must venture into the four elemental trial chambers and place the cleansed seal remnants onto their respective elemental shrines.

Gameplay Mechanics & Puzzles

- **Hub World Hub Navigation:** The player can tackle the four elemental trial chambers in any order from the Central Rotunda.
- **Diegetic Artifact Placement**: Sora physically inspects her satchel and places the cleansed remnants (Bronze Token fragment, Silver Betel Box inlay, Terracotta Jar soil, Molten Iron ingot) onto matching elemental altars.

Act II: The Four Elemental Trials (1:00 – 2:30)

Narrative Narrative & Chamber Mechanics

Each chamber tests one of the core gameplay skills Sora has mastered throughout her journey:

1. **Earth Trial (Sight & Line-of-Sight)**: Sora must navigate a maze of Banyan roots where stone statues shift position only when she turns her back. She must use her lamp shutter and careful camera positioning to freeze statues in place and clear paths.
2. **Water Trial (Light Reflection Puzzle)**: Sora rotates ancient polished bronze mirrors across submerged stone basins, aiming a beam of moonlight to strike three crystal gems on an Apsara wall relief to drain the central basin.
3. **Wind Trial (Audio Stealth & Wind Timing)**: Sora must cross a narrow stone bridge over a chasm. Heavy wind gusts mask her footsteps, but when the wind stops, *Pret* entities lurk in the shadows. She must move only when wind gusts howl, remaining completely motionless when the air goes silent.
4. **Fire Trial (Resource Management & Timing)**: A timed sequence where Sora must light a series of stone braziers using her remaining matchboxes and oil lamp in a precise geometric order while dodging moving fire traps.

Act III: The Severance Ritual & Multiple Endings (2:30 – 4:00)

Narrative

With all four elemental shrines activated, the heavy stone blast doors of the Central Rotunda slide open, revealing The Sanctum of the Banyan Tree.

In the center of the sanctum lies the Golden Inscription Slab (The Fifth & Final Seal) holding the original blood contract signed in 1910. As Sora approaches, the

ground trembles. The Neak Ta Guardian manifests in its full, terrifying physical form—a multi-armed entity of dark shadow and ancient stone, towering over the altar.

Gameplay Mechanics & Boss Ritual Sequence

Sora cannot fight the entity with conventional weapons. Instead, she must complete the Ritual of Severance across three high-intensity phases while evading the Neak Ta's area-of-effect attacks and shadow tendrils:

1. **Phase 1 (The Four Corners)**: Run to the four corner pillars of the sanctum, tie blessed white cotton thread (*Sai Sin*) around each pillar, and light sanctified incense.
2. **Phase 2 (The Chants)**: Interact with the central altar to recite counter-mantras using interactive text selection prompts corresponding to funeral chants (*Smat*) recorded in her sketchbook. Incorrect choices cause shadow damage.
3. **Phase 3 (The Blood Sacrifice)**: Place her own blood onto the Golden Inscription Slab using a brass pin to officially nullify the ancestral lineage debt.

Multiple Endings

The Good Ending: The Unbroken Freedom (True Ending)

- **Conditions**: Achieved if the player maintained cultural taboos, collected all hidden lore notes, and completed the ritual chants without error.
- **Resolution**: As Sora places her blood onto the slab and recites the final chant, a blinding golden light erupts from the Banyan tree. The Neak Ta entity lowers its hands, bows its masked head in respect, and dissolves into glowing particles of dust. The dark night sky above the open temple dome transitions into a breathtaking golden sunrise. Sora walks out of the mountain catacombs into the morning sun, free from the past. Back in Battambang, Uncle Sok's cremation fire burns peacefully under a clear sky as her family finds peace.

The Bad Ending: Bound to the Soil

- **Conditions**: Achieved if the player made major errors in the chanting sequence or failed key lore choices throughout the game.
- **Resolution**: Sora completes the ritual, but the counter-mantra is incomplete. The Neak Ta rejects the severance, declaring the debt unpaid. Darkness

consumes the sanctum. Sora wakes up inside the wooden coffin back at the Battambang stilt house in Episode 1, trapped in the spirit realm forever while her family mourns over her lifeless body in the real world.

5. Audio & Visual Specification Sheet

Feature	Design Specification
Color Palette	Ancient sandstone grey, moss green, emissive rune gold, glowing amber, deep navy blue transitioning to golden dawn sunlight.
Post-Processing	Full WebGL bloom, volumetric light shafts through the ceiling dome, screen distortion during boss attacks, film grain.
Light Sources	Oil lantern, glowing golden runes, stone braziers, dynamic moonlight transitioning to sunlight.
Primary Ambience	Booming subterranean bass, wind howling through stone grilles, dripping water, traditional Pinpeat music (slow, ominous Roneat woodblock chords).
Horror Sound Cues	Stone blocks sliding, multi-layered echo voice of Neak Ta, roaring wind, shattering glass, ritual chanting.
UI Design	100% Diegetic. Inventory, ritual chants, and puzzle solutions tracked exclusively in Sora's sketchbook satchel.